The Hammer Circle

The Association of
British Hammer Throwers
Founded 1952

THE DON ANTHONY OLYMPIAN AWARD

Don was one of the founder members of the Hammer Circle and had a highly successful 10-year international career resulting in a very respectable 12th place in the 1956 Melbourne Olympics. He also competed at the 1954 Commonwealth Games in Vancouver and the 1958 Games in Cardiff. In his Olympic year he broke the English native record several times and set his official lifetime best of 59.94m. Don also founded the Amateur Volleyball Association of Great Britain in 1955.

In 2007 Don received the IOC award for "Sport and promotion of Olympism". Olympism is a social philosophy which emphasises the role of sport in world development, international understanding, peaceful co-existence, and social and moral education. "One of the greatest achievements, therefore, of any athlete is to become an Olympian".

The Don Anthony Olympian Award will be available on occasions that someone related to the Hammer Circle, or the sport itself, embodies the principle of Olympism in an exceptional way that deserved suitable recognition

The inaugural award was provided and presented by Jean and Shaun Pickering at the Hammer Circle's 60th Anniversary Dinner in Bedford for their wonderful achievements as the youngest participants to qualify for the Final in their first Olympic Games in London 2012 - Sophie Hitchon and Alex Smith

The 2016 award was presented to Sophie Hitchon for her tremendous achievements in the final of the Rio Olympics in breaking the British Record and taking the Bronze medal. Sophie showed exceptional strength and determination in the competition having entered the Olympic final ranked only 20th in the world.

The Tokyo 2020 Olympics were postponed to 2021 due to the global pandemic. Nick Miller and Taylor Campbell represented Team GB and currently top the UK All-time rankings. Nick finished 6th in the final with 78.15m which is the best performance by a UK male hammer thrower at the Olympics since 1924. Taylor threw 71.34m in the qualifying round although had achieved four comps over 75m in 2021. Engraved Japanese Okishima Glass Bowls were presented by HC President Alan Woods at the 2021 Reunion in Hull to Taylor and to Nick's father, Len.

With no hammer throwers at the Paris 2024 Games, it didn't go un-noticed that a long-standing member of the Hammer Circle, Nick Percy, finally secured his place on the GB Olympic Team for the discus which was duly recognised by the Hammer Circle.